



First electron capture supernova

Scientists spotted an electron-capture supernova for the first time.
<https://digit.in/july21-116>

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HI

Quick "current" story - 61 years old, still playing occasionally. As a "corporate" drone, one is perceived as "childish" if I discuss games but then I discovered a 25+ colleague who is into gaming. Now he is 35+ and he says "my son games now." :)

Back story - first PC in 1997 a windows 95. Integrated graphics. First EVER game in life - Steel Panthers 1. It was love at first sight and since then I haven't lost my love or fascination for Turn Based games as it is "comfortable" for old timers like me. Later I also played RTS like Company of Heroes 1 and 2, Call of Duty 1,2, WaW (whatever iterations). Couple of FPS shooters like Battlefield. The best RTS is a toss up between CoH 1 and World in Conflict. As you have probably guessed by now, I am "into" wargames and "military" games. I even wrote an article for the erstwhile SKOAR magazine in the last issue (sept.1999?) which was a special on WW2 games; my article was titled "5 WW2 games that you can play without selling your kidney." (And you can guess which was no.1 in that)

Which brings us to the "growing up"/ "getting old" part and why gorgeous graphics can't hide what

is essentially a tired game which is probably a recycle of some other game with which you fell in love when it first came out.

My take is that pretty soon most games beat the same path and soon we are in "meh" territory - much like film genres becoming repetitive! The excitement of winning a battle against the computer - or a human opponent by email!!! - is no longer the same. When I take a look at "new wargames", it's all meh because it's the same old Steel Panthers 1 campaigns recycled again and again to the point of boredom. With great trepidation I recently bought "strategic mind" from Steam (yes I have an account) and the first campaign was predictably the same as in Panzer Corps 1 which in itself was a retread of Panzer General 3D which was you guessed it - all roads lead to Steel Panthers 1.

To be fair to everyone, I haven't tried any other games like RPG, Western shooters, fantasy or other genres but I am sure the experience of "then and now" will be somewhat

similar for most gamers who are into these genres. The novelty of being "first" soon wears off and the earlier excitement soon leads to boredom.

Somewhere in between I did some flight sims but pretty soon the system requirements got humongous and that too became a meh though I am astounded by the stunning details posted on Youtube about some "flights".

Last but not the least - Civilization VI is on my TBP (To Be Played) List! That genre too has grown and I suppose we can say that its roots are in the classic Age of Empires which is my wife's favorite game (she plays it occasionally nowadays as she has finished all the campaigns). Lets hope there is an AoE IV which I keep hearing about every now and then.

I have found some online forums where 60+ gamers like me still enjoy the comfort factor of a Turn Based game.

As to whether this old gamer will keep gaming is a big question as the balance between work, play (writing - please check out this blatant shameless self plugging of my new book on Indian war films <https://amzn.to/3xE8cuh>), films (Netflix) is something that is to be yet managed. The list of TBP keeps growing and so does the experience counter in the brain which says "will this also be a 'meh' game".

-Ciao
KVR



Hey KVR,

If I find myself living your life 30 years down the line, I'll know that I've lived a good life! You should definitely give some other genres a go, you never know what you might stumble upon. :)

-Manish



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